



INDIAN COUNCIL FOR MEDICAL RESEARCH THE BODY GUARD

- More than 1,00,000 women were rejected by their families on account of TB.
- 12.13 per cent of 6,100 houses and 10.49 per cent of 42,739 water containers were detected with *Stegomyia argypti*, a mosquito that spreads dengue, Chikungunya and yellow fever.
- With the help of GIS, mosquitoes were tracked for the first time in Bhimtaal, Uttarakhand. These aren't headlines made by an international agency, but different fields of medicine, all converging on the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR).

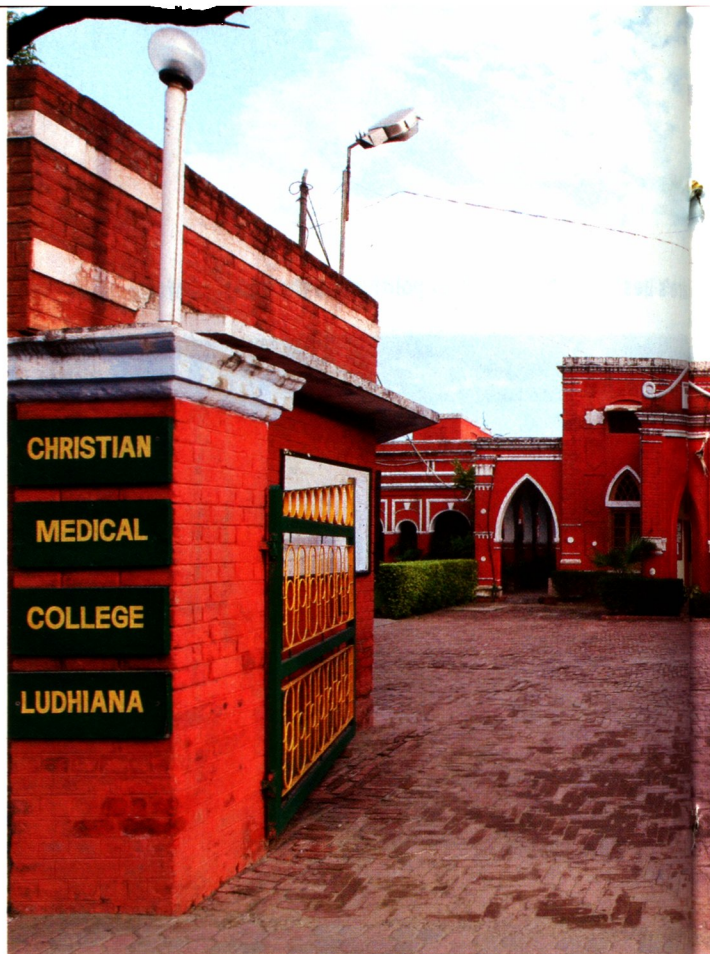
Covering fields like malaria, animal science, TB and AIDS, the ICMR has made many headlines. Founded as the Indian Research Fund Association (IRFA) in 1911, it was renamed ICMR in 1949 and made the apex institution for bio-medical research. Its 29 permanent institutions and 13 centres for advanced research follow the research-invention-execution-upgradation method. Having adopted the latest technology and extended its reach from the rural to the urban, ICMR stands at par with its international counterparts.

by Purvi Malhotra

CURE FOR SURE ICMR's National Institute of Cholera and Enteric Diseases, Kolkata, discovered a new strain of cholera called 0139 Bengal, while its Tuberculosis Research Centre, Chennai, was the first to advocate the Directly Observed Treatment Short Course for the domiciliary treatment of TB. The National Institute of Malaria Research has developed Rapid Diagnostic Sticks to help detect malaria, without a doctor's help.



RUBEN SINGH



CHRISTIAN MEDICAL COLLEGE, LUDHIANA AND VELLORE HEALING HANDS

"Care and commitment since 1894". This unvarnished motto of the Christian Medical College (CMC) and Hospital in Ludhiana underscores the spirit of the British-era institution, which is the pride of the industrious city. From the dream of a British girl who sailed to India with only £60, the CMC has traversed a long journey marked by the missionary zeal of its founder—Edith Mary Brown. In 1882, she completed her medical training from Cambridge, which qualified her to work in India. Her dream opportunity came in 1891 when A. Greenfield, head of the Zenana Mission in Ludhiana, sought a woman doctor to take charge of the newly set up Charlotte Hospital. Soon she established an institution to train female doctors. Back in

England, she raised £60 for her venture—the North India School of Medicine for Christian Women in 1894, nurturing it until her retirement in 1941. In 1953, the institute was rechristened as CMC to make men eligible for admission and an MBBS degree was introduced. Spread over 45 acre in the heart of the city, it has grown into a multi-speciality, tertiary healthcare institution. Even half a century later, CMC continues to be known as the "Miss Brown Hospital".

A similar spirit suffuses the CMC, Vellore. Ida Sophia Scudder, from a family of medical missionaries, came to settle in Vellore, Tamil Nadu, in the 1900s. One night, she was asked to help three women struggling with difficult childbirth. The three women did not survive.